

CATEGORIES OF TRAUMA THAT PEOPLE EXPERIENCE

Situational: traumas involve those traumatic events that are not perpetrated by other people that the person may know for instance car accidents terrorist attacks or natural disasters such as hurricanes fires and earthquakes.

Relational: traumas are interpersonal in nature because another person is the perpetrator, often someone who should be trustworthy or has significant power in the child or adult's life.

Acute/Single Event: This is a onetime traumatic event.

Adverse Childhood Trauma: these are the specific adverse childhood experiences described in ACEs study and include those that are being added as researchers determine additional specific adversities that have contributed to long term negative physical and emotional outcomes.

Attachment Trauma: traumas related to the experiences of attachment in early life. Healthy development occurs when there are secure attachments and when there are insecure attachments, a person can be crippled from having meaningful relationships throughout life.

Chronic Trauma: these are traumas that occur repeatedly.

Developmental Trauma: traumas associated with interrupting normal developmental tasks such as trust building in the early months of life or gaining a sense of autonomy coupled with the ability to be inter-relational.

Complex Trauma: where there are a variety of traumas making the overall impact even more difficult to assess and understand there are elements of unpredictability and chaos.

Trans- General Trauma: this speaks to traumas being passed from one generation to the next often impacted by the powerful forces of loyalty to family beliefs and behaviors.

Vicarious Trauma: a category of traumatization that occurs when someone hears about or witnesses someone else's traumatic experience. The person vicariously traumatized can experience the same symptoms of someone who was traumatized.

Racial trauma: or race-based traumatic stress, is the cumulative effects of racism on an individual's mental and physical health.